

Arranged Marriages

Match Fixing

THE DEMANDS OF THE FAMILY
CONTINUE TO OUTWEIGH THE
PRIMACY OF THE COUPLE, EXALTED
IN MODERN WESTERN SOCIETIES

■ By Sudhir Kakar

The consensus in favour of arranged marriages in our country through the centuries has been truly astonishing. The only text that I know which considers love marriage as the highest form of marriage is the revolution-

ary *Kamasutra*. What is perhaps even more surprising is that arranged marriages are not only a pan-Indian norm, cutting across divides in education, social class, religion and regions but, more important, they are rarely seen as an imposition by the young people who overwhelmingly

prefer them to the love marriage, which is so typical of Western societies.

The INDIA TODAY AC Nielsen-ORG-MARG survey is no different. Not only are 80 per cent of the marriages of the respondents arranged but also 77 per cent prefer such arrangements to love marriages. There is, of

course, a wide variety of marriages that fall under the rubric "arranged", depending on how much a young girl or boy participates in, or even guides the process of selecting a mate. At one extreme is an arrangement where the young people never meet before marriage and are



What sort of marriage did you have?

		MALE	FEMALE
Arranged by family, relatives	80	79	81
Love marriage	19	20	18

All figures in per cent. Rest: Don't know/ Won't say.

THE DANCER PERFORMED WELL.
THE INSTRUCTOR GAVE HER
SEVERAL ZEROES AS A REWARD.

KAMASUTRA DOTTED CONDOMS. WHO DO YOU WANT TO BE TONIGHT?

